First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Monday: 2pm-4pm; Tuesday 8am-2pm; Wednesday 9am-Noon; Thursday 8am-2pm; Friday 10am-Noon.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: Tues. & Wed, 9am-12pm, and by appt.
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Sandy Cristman

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

October 29, 2023

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Monica Newton, Office Manager

27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Twenty-Second Sunday after Pentecost October 29, 2023

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words**:**
Being deeply loved by someone gives you strength, while loving someone deeply gives you courage." — Lao Tzu

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude *We Shall Overcome* Traditional

Welcome and Announcements

Sung Call To Worship Come and Fill Our Hearts (Taizé)

Come and fill our hearts with your peace,
You alone, O God, are holy.
Come and fill our hearts with your peace,
Al-le-lu--ia!

Call To Worship

All: Within this community

One: We experience God's unconditional love

All: Within this community

One: We rejoice in the risen Christ

All: Within this community

One: We awaken to the Holy Spirit

All: Within this community

One: We join together in worship

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and a full pantry, fridge, and freezer stock of food.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:
Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
First Congregational Church of St Albans
Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative. Including, Adorn Aprons and Franklin County Quilt Guild.

WH works with local housing case workers from:
F/GI Community Action
Voices Against Violence
Samaritan House
Restorative Justice Center
Pathways
Reach-Up

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)** From the Prayer of Saint Francis

Lord, make us instruments of your peace.
Where there is hatred let us sow love;
Where there is injury, pardon;
Where there is discord, union;
Where there is doubt, faith;
Where there is despair, hope;
Where there is darkness, light;
Where there is sadness, joy.

Hymn*

"There's a Wideness in God's Mercy" NCH 23

Prayer of Confession[1] **(Unison)**

Loving God, sometimes I am not aware that you are with me always. Sometimes I can't remember that you watch out for me at all times. Sometimes I forget that you always love me. Sometimes I need to remember that everyone on this earth is my brother and sister and that you love all the people of the world. Thank you, God, for your love. Amen

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Time with Children

Anthem *A New Commandment* Richard Hubbard

Scripture Readings

Matthew 22:34-46

Morning Reflection

"Love Is All There Is"

HYMN*

"Help Us Accept Each Other" (1, 2, 4) NCH 388

THE THANKSGIVING

SHARING OUR JOYS AND CONCERNS

CHORAL CALL TO PRAYER

Hear Our Prayer, O lord D. Welpton

PASTOR'S PRAYER~

LORD'S PRAYER

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

CHORAL RESPONSE TO PRAYER

"*THOU WILT KEEP HIM IN PERFECT PEACE, WHOSE MIND IS STAYED ON THEE.*"
SCOTTISH PSALTER, 1615

OFFERTORY

DOXOLOGY

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

OFFERTORY PRAYER

THE DEPARTURE

HYMN*

"Go Now In Peace" BB 14

BENEDICTION

POSTLUDE *LOOK AT THE MOON* S. CONRADY

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

ANNOUNCEMENTS:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- ★ Greg Beeman, Joel Magnuson, Paula Kane Thank You for producing another GREAT Open-Mic night!
- ★ Melissa Beeman Thank You for a full growing season's worth of beautiful altar flowers from your gardens!

Ride Volunteers
We are in search of volunteers to help provide rides. These rides consist of helping people get to and from church for services and events. If you would like to volunteer or are looking for a ride, please contact the office @ (802)524-4555 or email using: info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org.

Annual Meeting
November 12- after church

Zoom Bible Study
Our next Bible Study will meet on November 1
Fellowship 6:45pm;
Bible Study 7:00- 8:00pm
Text: Matthew 23: 1-12
You can join us at any time, call Pastor Jessica for the Zoom link

Concert Announcement: On Sun Nov 12 at 3pm we welcome David Feurzeig, pianist, on his quest to Play Every Town in Vermont. These 252 community concerts are a demonstration of staying local in order to reduce burden on the environment. He will be joined by special guest Betsy Leblanc, a professional clarinettist from St. Albans.

Music Notes: This morning's anthem text is technically from the gospel of John ("A new command I give you: Love one another"), which is itself a reiteration from today's lectionary in Matthew: 22:39 'You shall love your neighbor as yourself.'